

TERM: _____ WEEK: _____

NAME: _____



YEAR 7

FAIRY TALES



What are Fairy Tales?

Fairy tales are a type of narrative. They were originally part of a vast oral tradition of storytelling. This means that people used to tell these tales to others verbally, and as a result they were passed down from generation to generation. Because of this, their history is difficult to pinpoint until they were written down. Once a fairy tale is written down it is known as a *literary fairy tale*.



Some of the more famous fairy tales first came into print in 1697 and were recorded by Charles Perrault. These included Cinderella, Sleeping Beauty and Little Red Riding Hood. Later, in 1812, Jacob and Wilhelm Grimm (also known as The Brothers Grimm) recorded other classics including 'Rapunzel', 'Hansel and Gretel', and 'Rumpelstiltskin'. Hans Christian Andersen is considered a master of the form and most of the fairy tales he recorded were original. He published his first tales in a book called *Fairy Tales Told for Children* in 1835 and many of his stories are still well known today, including 'The Little Mermaid' and 'The Ugly Duckling'.

Fairy tales are set in the everyday world, but they aren't realistic; animals talk, the wind gives advice, and the dead spring back to life. The tales aren't usually set in the here and now; or in any identifiable time or place—they exist in the state of 'once upon a time'. Their characters are often nameless, or have generic names, as if to remind us that wonderful things can happen to anyone. And that strange and wondrous things can happen is never questioned: anything is possible. A child can become a bird, a man a monster, a girl in rags a Queen. Things can change for the better and justice will prevail. There are some fairy tales without a happily ever after—but there are no fairy tales in which no one is transformed. Listed below are some common elements that appear in fairy tales.

Common Elements of Fairy Tales

- "Once upon a time..." as the opening line.
- Fantasy. Fantasy means an 'alternate reality'. This just means a new world that operates very differently to what we would consider as 'normal'. An example would be the enchanted forest.
- Clearly defined Good characters vs. Evil characters.
- Royalty present such as a beautiful princess/handsome prince.
- Magic (extraordinary events that happen in a 'normal' world). Examples of magic in fairy tales include giants, elves, talking animals, witches or fairies.
- A problem that needs to be solved.
- Repetition. Words or phrases may be repeated, or there may be several attempts at solving a problem.
- Poverty as a theme. For example, there may be a poor working girl or shepherd.
- Sibling rivalry (oldest versus youngest).
- Happy endings – "they all lived happily ever after."
- A moral they are trying to teach (often to teach children not to talk to strangers or wander too far from home).

Three Roses

This is the story of a gardener who grew the most beautiful single rose the world had ever seen. It was a black rose, which was unlikely, and it bloomed the whole year round, which was impossible.

Hearing of this rose, the King decided to see it for himself. With his entourage, he rode for seven days to the gardener's simple cottage. On the morning of the seventh day, he arrived and saw the rose. It was even more beautiful than the King had imagined, and he wanted it.

'How did you come to grow such a beautiful rose?' the King asked the gardener, who was standing silently by.

'I planted that rose on the day my wife died,' replied the gardener, looking only at the flower. 'It is a true, deep black, the very colour of her hair. The rose grew from my love of her.'

The King turned to his servants and said, 'Uproot this rosebush and take it to the palace. It is too beautiful for anyone but me.'

But when the rosebush was transplanted to the palace, it lasted only a year before it withered and died. The King, who had gazed upon it every day, angrily decided that it was the gardener's fault, and he set out at once to punish him.

But when he arrived at the gardener's cottage, he was amazed to see a new rosebush growing there, with a single rose. But this rose was green, and even more beautiful than the black rose.

The King once again asked the gardener how he came to grow such a beautiful rose.

'I planted this rose on the anniversary of my wife's death,' said the gardener, his eyes only on the rose. 'It is the colour of her eyes, which I looked into every morning. The new rose grew from my love of her.'

'Take it!' commanded the King, and he turned away to ride the seven days back to his palace. Such a beautiful flower was not fit for a common man.

The green rose bloomed for two years, and the King looked upon it every day, for it brought him great contentment. Then, one morning, it was dead, the bush withered, the petals fallen to the ground. The King picked up the petals and spoke to no one for two days. Then he said, as if to convince himself, 'The gardener will have another rose.'

So once again he rode off with his entourage. This time, they took a spade and the palace jardinier.

Such was the King's impatience that they rode for half the nights as well as days, but there were wrong turns and flooded bridges, and it still took seven days before he once again rode up to the gardener's cottage. And there was a new rosebush, with a single rose. A red rose, so beautiful that the King's men were struck silent and the King himself could only stare and gesture to the palace jardinier to take it away.

Even though the King didn't ask, the gardener spoke before the spade broke the earth around the bush.

'I planted this rose three years after the death of my wife,' he said. 'It is the colour of her lips, which I first kissed under a harvest moon on the hottest of summer nights. This rose grew from my love of her.'

The King seemed not to hear but kept staring at the rose. Finally, he tore his gaze away and turned his horse for home.

The jardinier watched him go and stopped digging for a moment.

'Your roses are the most beautiful I have ever seen,' he said. 'They could only grow from a great love. But why grow them only to have these memories taken away from you?'

The gardener smiled and said, 'I need nothing to remind me of my wife. When I walk alone under the night sky, I see the blackness of her hair. When the light catches the green glass of a bottle, I see her eyes. When the sun is setting all red against the hills and the wind touches my cheek, I feel her kiss.'

'I grew the first rose because I was afraid I might forget. When it was gone, I knew that I had lost nothing. No one can take the memory of my love.'

The jardinier frowned, and he began to cut again with his spade. Then he asked, 'But why do you keep growing the roses?'

'I grow them for the King,' said the gardener. 'He has no memories of his own, no love. And after all, they are only flowers.'

Read the story 'Three Roses' by Garth Nix and answer the questions below. Make reference to the story to justify your answers where possible.

1. Identify two examples of imagery and explain what you think they mean. **(4 marks)**

Example 1 **(4 marks)**

Example 2 **(4 marks)**

2. Explain why the gardener grew the roses. **(2 marks)**

3. Why did it not upset the gardener when the roses were taken away? **(2 marks)**

4. From your reading of the story, what do you think the word 'jardinier' means?

Use evidence to support your answer.

(2 marks)

5. Why do you think the roses died when they were transplanted?

(2 marks)

6. Describe the character of the King. Why do you think he acted the way he did?

Give evidence from the story to explain your choices.

(6 marks)

7. Describe a situation or a time when you have had a similar experience to the gardener, the King or the King's servants, and explain the similarities. (5 marks)

Notes for Question 8

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9. List the Fairy Tale conventions that have been used in this story (2 marks)

10. What do you think is the moral of this fairy tale. Why do you think this? (2 marks)

Compose a 500-700 word fairy tale that draws upon the idea of conflict. This may be internal conflict (with oneself) or external conflict (with other characters, society or the environment).

[illegible]

